MICASE

MICASE Manual

The Michigan Corpus of Academic Spoken English

Version 3, Work in Progress, dated June 8, 2007

http://www.lsa.umich.edu/eli/micase/index.htm



The English Language Institute
University of Michigan

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All document structure numbers in this document (i.e., cross-references to section headings or tables) are clickable hyperlinks (not visibly marked) which you may use to jump directly to the relevant section. All headings in the table of contents and all web addresses (URLs) and e-mail addresses are also 'live' hyperlinks.

Questions or comments about any aspect of MICASE may be sent to micase@umich.edu or to MICASE, English Language Institute, University of Michigan, 500 E. Washington Street, Ann Arbor, Michigan, MI 48104-2028, USA.

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Chapter 1

Introduction and history

In late 1997, the English Language Institute (ELI) at the University of Michigan started a major research project to create a resource for studying academic speech. The goal of the project was to record and transcribe close to 200 hours (approximately 1.8 million words) of academic speech from across the university. In June 2001, we finished the recording goal, with over 190 total hours recorded. In April 2002, we completed transcribing and proofreading all the transcripts. (The digital sound recordings were transcribed with the help of a computer program called SoundScriber, developed by former research assistant Eric Breck.)

Analysis is supported by a customized search engine developed for us by the Humanities Text Initiative section of the University Library and by Alan Pagliere. The entire corpus is available on-line at http://micase.umdl.umich.edu/m/micase/. This search engine is notable for the large number of speaker and speech-event categories that can be selected, and the user-friendly interface. The search engine has increased in popularity each year since its launch, approaching an impressive 140,000 hits in 2006.

The MICASE corpus is a spoken language corpus of approximately 1.8 million words (nearly 200 hours) focusing on contemporary university speech within the microcosm of the University of Michigan, in Ann Arbor, Michigan. This is a typical large public research university with about 37,000 students, approximately one-third of whom are graduate students. Speakers represented in the corpus include faculty, staff, and all levels of students, and native, near-native, and non-native speakers.

The ELI has committed resources to MICASE for a series of interlocking reasons. First, before this project, there was no database of this kind available. Second, we strongly suspect that once we are able to examine the corpus for recurrent grammatical and phraseological patterns, we will find many divergences from those described in current grammar and vocabulary books, which have largely relied on introspection or on features of written texts. MICASE thus provides authentic material in sufficient quantity to redefine our concepts of academic speech. Third, we eventually hope to be able to track generalized changes in speech patterns as people gain experience of university culture. (Although we know quite a lot about how academic writing evolves as students

progress, our current perceptions of speech changes within academic cultures are largely anecdotal.) Fourth, with all this new information, we—and others elsewhere—will be in a better position to develop more appropriate ESL and English for Academic Purposes teaching and testing materials, and to evaluate how best to incorporate corpus work into EAP programs.

Chapter 2

Corpus content and structure

In this chapter, basic information is given about the types of texts you can find in MICASE, allowing an overall view of the types of speakers and speech events that have been included.

2.1 Academic speech

Academic events vary widely in their tone, substance, and length. The MICASE corpus includes speech events that range in length from 19 to 178 minutes, with word counts ranging from 2,805 words to 30,328 words. In the MICASE corpus, *academic speech* is defined as that speech which occurs in academic settings. In other words, it is not predefined as something like "scholarly discussion." In academic settings, we might, for example, find such speech acts as jokes, confessions, and personal anecdotes, as well as definitions, explanations, and intellectual justifications. Therefore, the MICASE researchers have taken pains to record a wide variety of academic speech events. Most speech events are fully recorded, from beginning to end, because the beginnings and ends of academic speech events may be of particular interest to researchers.

Certain events that occur on campus may not qualify as academic speech events, either because they would not be significantly different if they had occurred in other locations, or because they are not particular to a university community's educational mission or research agenda. For example, we did not record food-ordering sequences in university food outlets or office talk among co-workers in various university support staff departments and offices.

The 152 speech events in the corpus include:

Advising Sessions (2)
Colloquia (Public Lectures) (14)
Discussion Sections (9)
Dissertation Defenses (4)
Interviews (3)
Lab Sections (8)

Lectures (Small and Large) (62)
Meetings (6)
Office Hours (14)
Seminars (7)
Service Encounters (2)
Student Presentations (11)
Study Groups (8)
Tours (Campus/Museum) (2)

2.2 Structure of the corpus

The corpus was designed to be balanced, as much as possible, across several categories of academic speech events as well as across the major academic divisions within the university. Academic events in the professional schools (i.e., medical, dental, business, law) were excluded. The range of speech events includes monologic and interactive speech; undergraduate and graduate students; junior faculty, senior faculty, and staff; and native, near-native, and non-native speakers of English. Furthermore, an attempt was made to get approximately equal amounts of speech from male and female speakers within each academic division. For a detailed breakdown of the word counts and percentages of speech by each category of speaker and within the two major speech event categories, see Chapter 4 of this manual.

Each speech event in MICASE is categorized according to various contextual attributes, and these attributes can be found in the header of each transcript. Speech event attributes include the type of event, the subject area of the event, the extent to which an event is monologic or interactive, as well as the academic role or level of the majority of participants (e.g., whether the class was a graduate or an undergraduate class, or whether a meeting was primarily of senior faculty members). A description of all the speech event attributes and their corresponding codes is found in the table in section 2.3. Similarly, all speakers in the corpus were classified according to several different demographic variables (e.g., gender and age), which can be found in the table in section 2.4.

2.3 Speech event attributes

SPEECH EVENT TYPE		
CLASSROOM EVENTS *NOTE: All classroom speech events are defined externally by the university regardless of the actual speech event characteristics, except in cases where prepared student presentations constitute the majority of the speech, in which case the event type is Student Presentations.*		
SMALL LECTURES	LES	Lecture class; class size = 40 or fewer students
LARGE LECTURES	LEL	Lecture class; class size = more than 40 students

DISCUSSION SECTIONS	DIS	Additional section of a lecture class designed for maximum student participation; may also be called recitation
LAB SECTIONS	LAB	Lab sections of science and engineering classes; may include problem solving sessions
SEMINARS	SEM	Any class defined as a seminar (primarily graduate level)
STUDENT PRESENTATIONS	STP	Class other than a seminar in which one or more students speak in front of the class or lead discussion
NON-CLASS EVENTS		
ADVISING SESSIONS	ADV	Interactions between students and academic advisors
COLLOQUIA	COL	Departmental or University-wide lectures, panel discussions, workshops, brown bag lunch talks, etc.
DISSERTATION DEFENSES	DEF	Ph.D. theses defenses
INTERVIEWS	INT	Interviews for research purposes
MEETINGS	MTG	Faculty, staff, student government, research group meetings, not including study group meetings
OFFICE HOURS	OFC	Held by faculty or graduate student instructors in connection with a specific class or project
SERVICE ENCOUNTERS	SVC	Library, computer center, financial aid office services
STUDY GROUPS	SGR	Informal student-led study groups, one time or on-going
TOURS	TOU	Campus, library, or museum tours

ACADEMIC DIVISION AND DISCIPLINE	
Academic discipline corresponds to individual university departments when applicable; otherwise assigned as miscellaneous. *Academic division* refers to one of four divisions defined according to the Horace H. Rackham School of Graduate Studies classification of departments.	
BIOLOGICAL AND HEALTH SCIENCES (BS)	Includes Biology, Biochemistry, Dentistry, Genetics, Immunology, Natural Resources, Neuroscience, Nursing, Pathology, Pharmacy, Physiology, Public Health
PHYSICAL SCIENCES AND ENGINEERING (PS)	Includes Astronomy, Chemistry, Computer Science, Engineering (all), Geology, Mathematics, Physics, Statistics, Technical Communication
SOCIAL SCIENCES AND EDUCATION (SS)	Includes Anthropology, Business Administration, Communication, Economics, Education, History, Public Policy, Political Science, Psychology, Social Work, Sociology, Urban and Regional Planning
HUMANITIES AND ARTS (HA)	Includes Area Studies (all), Architecture, Classics, Comparative Literature, English, Fine Arts (all), Foreign Languages, History of Art, Information and Library Science, Linguistics, Philosophy, Women's Studies

PARTICIPANT LEVEL		
Corresponds to the level of the majority of students for classes, or participants for other events.		
JUNIOR UNDERGRAD	JU	First and second year undergraduates
SENIOR UNDERGRAD	SU	Third year and above undergraduates
MIXED UNDERGRAD	MU	Mixed undergraduates
JUNIOR GRADUATE	JG	First and second year or Master's level graduate students
SENIOR GRADUATE	SG	Third year and above Ph.D. students
MIXED GRADUATE	MG	Mixed grad students
SENIOR FACULTY	SF	Associate Professors and above
STAFF	ST	Non-teaching University employees
MIXED	MX	Mixed faculty, staff, students
INTERACTIVITY RATING		
Refers to the predominant type of discourse characterizing the speech event.		
HIGHLY MONOLOGIC	HM	One speaker monopolizes the floor in a lecture, occasionally with a few questions or brief comments
MOSTLY MONOLOGIC	MM	Primarily monologic discourse interspersed with some segments of interactive discourse
MIXED	MX	No one discourse mode is predominant
MOSTLY INTERACTIVE	MI	Primarily interactional discourse involving two or more speakers, interspersed with some longer segments of monologic discourse
HIGHLY INTERACTIVE	HI	Highly interactional discourse involving two or more speakers, with shorter turns and no monologic segments

2.4 Speaker attributes

CATEGORY	CODE	DEFINITION/COMMENTS
GENDER		
FEMALE	F	
MALE	M	
AGE GROUP		
17 - 23	1	
24 - 30	2	
31 - 50	3	
51 and older	4	
ACADEMIC ROLE		
JUNIOR UNDERGRAD	JU	First and second year undergraduates
SENIOR UNDERGRAD	SU	Third year and above undergraduates
JUNIOR GRADUATE	JG	First and second year or Master's level graduate students
SENIOR GRADUATE	SG	Third year and above Ph.D. students
JUNIOR FACULTY	JF	Lecturers and Assistant Professors
SENIOR FACULTY	SF	Associate Professors and above
RESEARCHER	RE	Non-teaching researchers
STAFF	ST	Non-teaching University employees
VISITOR/OTHER	VO	Non-University of Michigan affiliates
NATIVE SPEAKER STATUS		
NATIVE SPEAKER	NS	Native speakers of North American English
NATIVE SPEAKER OTHER	NSO	Native speakers of non-American English
NEAR NATIVE SPEAKER	NRN	Non-native speakers who consider English as their current dominant language and who appear to have native-like fluency and grammatical proficiency.
NON-NATIVE SPEAKER	NNS	Non-native speaker of English other than near-native speakers
FIRST LANGUAGE		
Only shown when first language is other than North American English.		

Chapter 3

Data collection, transcription, and mark-up

This chapter describes how the corpus data were recorded, transcribed, and marked up. It gives a full account of how words are spelled in the (various versions of the) corpus and other aspects of the transcription system

3.1 Data collection and recording methodology

Because MICASE aimed to record a wide range of academic speech, our sampling goals spanned fifteen different types of speech events and four major academic divisions within those types (e.g., humanities, social sciences, physical sciences and engineering, and biological sciences). (See section 2.3 above.) We adopted stratified random sampling as our preferred method of sampling. Each recording is classified according to speech event type, a pre-assigned number indicating the academic discipline, two letters representing the majority of participants in the event (e.g. junior undergraduate, senior graduate, senior faculty), and a final three digit sequence to track chronologically when the tape was recorded. For example, transcript number LEL115SU015 is a recording of a large lecture (LEL) in anthropology (115), at the senior undergraduate level (SU), and is the 15th speech event recorded for MICASE.

All recordings were made with a digital audio tape recorder with two external stereo microphones, and at selected events, a video recorder. Two researchers attended most speech events in order to identify speakers and facilitate transcription by taking field notes about nonverbal contextual information; however, in small groups (e.g. advising sessions, office hours, study groups) where an observer's presence would have been intrusive, the research assistants left the room after the equipment was set up. All speech was recorded with written consent from the major speakers and verbal consent from other participants. Demographic information (gender, age group, university position, and native language) was collected from each speaker on a form distributed at the end of each event. The speaker information is included in the header of each transcript

and is also entered into a separate database. All DAT recordings are captured and stored as MP3 format sound files for use with our computer transcription program, SoundScriber.

3.2 Corpus mark-up and annotation

The construction of MICASE was based on guidelines established by the Text Encoding Initiative (TEI) and files were originally marked up in SGML. We haved subsequently updated the corpus DTD (Document Type Definition) and converted all the files to the XML format.

At present, only the orthographically transcribed version of the corpus is available. Future releases of MICASE may have various kinds of linguistic annotation added: parts of speech, lemmas, and discourse-pragmatic categories. The part-of-speech tagger used on MICASE for in-house use is the CLAWS tagger developed at Lancaster University, UK (Appendix B gives the tag set adapted for use with our corpus).

3.2.1 Spelling, transcription, and mark-up conventions

The MICASE orthographic transcription conventions and mark-up system are intended to allow for ease of readability, while including enough detail to ensure adequate comprehension from the text of the transcript alone. To this end, we use standard orthography in the case of most words, except for select situations where standard conventions may cause confusion, and for a limited number of lexicalized abbreviations and grammatical constructions (e.g., *cuz, gonna, hafta, sorta*, and several others). We do not use standard punctuation, but instead mark pauses of varying lengths with commas, periods, and ellipses. We also use question marks to identify phrases that function pragmatically as questions.

All backchannel cues and hesitation or filler words were transcribed using a set number of normalized orthographic representations that disregard minor phonetic variations. These, like overlaps and interruptions, are transcribed in a way that illustrates their sequential occurrence, but still indicates which speaker holds the floor.

We originally used a customized set of SGML tags adapted from the TEI conventions, which have since been converted to XML. Additionally, all the speaker demographic information and recording information is tagged in the header. Our transcripts were first created using Author Editor, an SGML text editing program. After the XML conversion, we used XMLSpy.

The tables below give a complete description of the spelling, transcription, and mark-up conventions (they are also available on the transcription conventions page on the MICASE website).

Table 3-1 Spelling Conventions

	RULE or GUIDELINE	EXAMPLES
GENERAL	Standard orthography is used for most words, even though they may not be fully pronounced, may be pronounced with a foreign accent, etc. In general, phonologically reduced forms are not represented, except as noted below.	
CAPITALIZATION	Only proper nouns (names, departments, course titles, organizations, etc.) are capitalized (in addition to acronyms; see below). Neither the beginnings of turns nor the pronoun 'i' are capitalized.	Dr Hales received his M-S and B-S degrees at Stanford in nineteen eighty-two. his PhD at Princeton in eighty-six under the Harold W Dodds Honorific Fellowship... oh, i i think i know what you're getting to.
FILLED PAUSES, BACKCHANNEL CUES, EXCLAMATIONS, etc.	All hesitation and filler words, backchannel cues, and transcribable exclamations are spelled out, as shown on the right.	**Hesitation/Filler Words/Backchannels**: hm, hm', huh, mm, mhm, uh, um, mkay **Yes/No Responses**: yes: mhm, mm, okey-doke, okey-dokey, uhuh, yeah, yep, yuhuh no: uh'uh, huh'uh, 'm'm, **Exclamations/Doubt/Misc**.: ach, ah, ahah, gee, jeez, oh, ooh, oop, oops, tch, ugh, uh'oh, whoa, yay
CONTRACTIONS and LEXICALIZED REDUCED FORMS	All standard contractions of *is, am, are, had, have, would, not* are represented, including [noun + *has been/have been/is*]. Different forms of modals + have are represented Lexicalized phonological reductions are limited to those listed on the right.	i'd, i've, i'm, i'll, she's, she'll, he's, they've, etc. that'll, it'll, there're etc. coulda, could've, couldn't, couldn've, couldna, woulda, would've, wouldn't, wouldn've, wouldna, shoulda, should've, shouldn't, shouldn've, shouldna betcha, cuz, 'em (=them), gimme, gotta, hafta, kinda, lookit (as vocative only), lotsa, lotta, oughta, sorta, wanna

ACRONYMS, ABBREVIATIONS, LETTERS AS VARIABLES	Acronyms are written in all caps. Three commonly abbreviated titles are left as abbreviations, but without periods. An acronym pronounced as a word is run together as one word. [On-line version only] When an acronym is spelled out, it appears in all caps with hyphens between each letter (except PhD). [In the CD-ROM/ distributed version and the tagged version, these hyphens have been removed.] Letters used as variables in math and science are written in all caps with hyphens between modifying or adjoining elements.	Exception: PhD (no hyphens, no period) Dr, Mr, Mrs (not spelled out) NASA, TOEFL C-I-A F-B-I E-L-I L-S-and-A X-Y axis N-squared, X-to-the-N-minus-one
HYPHENS	Standard hyphenation rules apply, as in the Chicago Manual of Style, where they exist.	pre-med, pre-calc, pre-law, mid-thirties mid-nineteen-ninety-nine, pre-Christian, non-Euclidean, non-native
NUMBERS	All numbers are fully spelled out as words. Standard hyphenation rules apply, with some additional guidelines: page numbers, course numbers, and room numbers are all hyphenated.	nineteen ten nineteen twenty-nine page one-fifty-seven Poli Sci one-sixty room thirty-twelve

REPETITIONS and REPAIRS	All repetitions of a word, partial word or phrase are transcribed. Truncated or cut-off words have a hyphen at the end of the last audible sound/letter. An underscore at the end of a word indicates a false start in which a whole word is spoken but then the speaker re-starts the phrase.	it's no longer than a than a, calendar year... so, come on up, grab yourself a ins- implement of destruction. well, it will be_ it's sort of_ it's a management human-resource kind of job...
FOREIGN WORDS	Foreign words are spelled as in the original language when it uses a roman alphabet; otherwise, an approximate phonetic transliteration is used. (Foreign words are italicized in the on-line version.)	and see what, the Buddha, was s- was saying um, the *tatha, gata*, Sanskrit's a really interesting language...
PRONUNCIATION VARIATIONS	As mentioned above, minor pronunciation variations are not represented in the spelling, with the exception of the contractions and lexicalized forms listed in this table.	

Table 3-2 Transcription and Mark-Up Conventions

XML TAG or SYMBOL	MEANING/DESCRIPTION	APPEARANCE IN ON-LINE TRANSCRIPTS (HTML VERSION)
SPEAKER ID		
<U WHO=S1>, <U WHO=S2>, etc.	Speaker IDs, assigned in the order they first speak.	**S1:** at the beginning of each turn or interruption/ back-channel.
<U WHO=SU>, <U WHO=SU-f>, <U WHO=SU-m>	Unknown speaker, without and with gender identified	**SU:** **SU-f, SU-m**
<U WHO=SU-1>	Probable but not definite identity of speaker	**SU-1:**
<SS>	Two or more speakers, in unison (used mostly for laughter)	**SS:**

PAUSES		
<PAUSE DUR=:05>	Pauses of 4 seconds or longer are timed to the nearest second.	<P: 05>
, [for untagged and on-line versions. Tagged version: <PAUSE DUR=":01" TYPE="CONT">]	Comma indicates a brief (1-2 second) mid-utterance pause with non-phrase-final intonation contour.	,
. [for untagged and on-line versions. Tagged version: <PAUSE DUR=":03" TYPE="FINAL">]	Period indicates a brief pause accompanied by an utterance final (falling) intonation contour; not used in a syntactic sense to indicate complete sentences.	.
... [for untagged and on-line versions. Tagged version: <PAUSE DUR=":03">]	Ellipses indicate a pause of 2-3 seconds	...
OVERLAPS		
<OVERLAP>...</OVERLAP>	This tag encloses speech that is spoken simultaneously, either at the ends and beginnings of turns, or as interruptions or backchannel cues in the middle of one speaker's turn. All overlaps are approximate and shown to the nearest word; a word is generally not split by an overlap tag.	Text of overlapping speech is in blue.
BACKCHANNEL CUES and FAILED INTERRUPTIONS		
Embedded utterance (<U> tag within a <U> tag)	Backchannel cues from a speaker who doesn't hold the floor and unsuccessful attempts to take the floor are embedded within the current speaker's turn, and not shown as a separate line/paragraph.	[S3: Text of embedded speech is in orange and surrounded by orange square brackets.]
Embedded and overlapped utterance (<OVERLAP> tag within an embedded utterance)	Backchannel cues or unsuccessful interruptions that overlap with the main speaker's speech.	[S3: Text of embedded speech that is overlapped is in blue and surrounded by orange speaker ID and square brackets.]
LAUGHTER		
<EVENT DESC=LAUGH> or <EVENT DESC=LAUGH WHO=S2>	All laughter is marked. Speaker ID not marked if current speaker laughs.	<LAUGH>, <S8 LAUGH> <SS LAUGH>, etc.

CONTEXTUAL EVENTS		
<EVENT DESC="WRITING ON BOARD"> <EVENT DESC="APPLAUSE"> <EVENT DESC="AUDIO DISTURBANCE">, <EVENT DESC="BACKGROUND NOISE"> <EVENT DESC="SOUND EFFECT">, <EVENT DESC="GASP">	Various contextual (non-speech) events are noted, usually only when they affect comprehension of the surrounding discourse.	<WRITING ON BOARD> <APPLAUSE> <AUDIO DISTURBANCE>, <BACKGROUND NOISE> <SOUND EFFECT>, <GASP>
READING PASSAGES		
<SEG TYPE="READING">.....</SEG>	Used when part of an utterance is read verbatim.	<READING>.....</READING>
FOREIGN WORDS		
<FOREIGN>.....</FOREIGN>	Used for non-English words or phrases.	Italics e.g.: the mother says *c'est quoi*? and Annika says to *parce que* eh and then,...
PRONUNCIATION VARIATIONS		
<SEG TYPE="PRON" SUBTYPE="/seltik/">Celtic</SEG>	Used when an unexpected pronunciation is used that would affect comprehension of the surrounding discourse. Dialect or other phonological variations are generally not represented.	Pronunciation guide follows the word e.g.: ...they asked the librarian for pictures of old Celtic <PRON: /seltik/> uniforms the basketball team, and it turns out that the project was he was supposed to find Celtic <PRON: /keltik/> costumes.
<SIC>...</SIC>	Used when a speaker makes a mistake without self-correcting, and the error might otherwise appear to be a transcribing error.	*(sic)* follows the word. e.g.: despite the fact that that was the era of Women's Liberation like i say on the cover of Newsweek, and Gloria Steinman *(sic)* and uh Betty Friedan...

UNCERTAIN or UNINTELLIGIBLE SPEECH		
(xx) (words) [See 3.3 below for the treatment of this in the POS-tagged version]	Two x's in parentheses indicate one or more words that are completely unintelligible. Words surrounded by parentheses indicate the transcription is uncertain.	i don't (xx) whole (xx) analysis it just struck me... lemme not write it that way (lest it be confused) with C syntax...
NAMES		
When participants' names occur in a recording, they are changed to pseudonyms in the transcript, except in the case of most public colloquia (i.e. COL-prefixed files). In some cases, names of non-present people referred to in the recording are also changed. There is no markup for names.		

3.3 Differences between the versions of MICASE

A version of MICASE became available via CD-ROM or downloadable zip file in July 2003 for a nominal fee (the order form can be downloaded from http://www.lsa.umich.edu/eli/micase/MICASE_OrderForm.pdf). This version is different in some ways from the on-line version:

3.3.2 Differences between the on-line version and the CD-ROM/ distributed version

- Only the distributed version of MICASE comes with the DTD (Document Type Definition), which specifies the elements, attributes, entities, and notations used in the XML transcripts.
- The web version contains extraneous mark-up that speeds up the on-line search engine.
- The speech for some speakers has been hidden/deleted, as per consent restrictions, in the web version.

3.3.3 Differences between the untagged and tagged versions

In the part-of-speech tagged version of MICASE (not publicly available) there are some other differences in mark-up. These changes were all in the direction of XMLizing all mark-up and non-text phenomena in order to ease processing by the CLAWS tagger. The changes are listed below:

- unintelligible speech (in parentheses in the untagged version) is represented by XML in the tagged version:

Untagged MICASE	Tagged MICASE
(xx)	<GAP DESC="UNINTELLIGIBLE"/>
(somethingorother)	<SEG TYPE="UNCLEAR">somethingorother</SEG>

- false starts (indicated by a trailing underscore character in the untagged version) are represented by XML in the tagged version:

Untagged MICASE	Tagged MICASE
`so there will be_ watch this okay`	`so there will be<STRUNC/> watch this okay`

- truncated words (followed by a hyphen in the untagged version) are enclosed within an XML element in the tagged version (NOTE: this means they no longer contribute to word counts and are not part of the flow of the text, unless specifically included):

Untagged MICASE	Tagged MICASE file
`somethingoroth-`	`<GAP DESC="somethingoroth-" REASON="TRUNC"/>`

- pauses are all consistently indicated by XML mark-up in the tagged version, as shown earlier in Table 3-2.

3.3.3.1 Spelling conventions and tokenization in the tagged version

In addition to the above differences in mark-up, some differences in the tagged version of MICASE have to do with the representation and analysis of 'words' in the transcripts:

- **spelled words** and **acronyms** (shown with hyphens between letters in the untagged version) appear without hyphens in the tagged version. The former are represented as sequences with spaces between the letters (e.g., `B-A-U-D-R-I-L-L-A-R-D` is `B A U D R I L L A R D` in the tagged version) while the latter appear as 'words' in their own right, unhyphenated (e.g., `E-L-I` is `ELI`; `C-U-N-O-three` is `CUNO-three`).
- **trailing enclitics** and "**fused forms**" have been re-tokenized by the tagger. Most of the words which are typically joined together in speech and spelled as they are pronounced (e.g., *he'll, let's, shouldn'ta*, *wanna*) have been **split up** into their 'component parts' in the tagged version. This affects mainly the modal verbs, but also forms such as *wanna, kinda,* and *sorta.* For example, *shouldn'ta* is transcribed as a single orthographic 'word' in the untagged version, but is re-tokenized and tagged as *should*_VM *n't*_XX *'ve*_VHI in the tagged version (i.e., as consisting of three 'morphemes': modal + negative + contracted infinitival *have*).
  A list of the enclitics and fused forms recognized and treated as two or more words by CLAWS can be found at the following URL, where the fused forms used in the British National Corpus (World Edition) are listed exhaustively:
  http://www.comp.lancs.ac.uk/ucrel/bnc2/fused.htm
  This list is not exhaustive for MICASE, however, and many of them do not apply to American speech.

- in a reverse direction to the above tokenisation rules, **multi-word expressions** of various kinds are treated as a **single** grammatical unit by the tagger. For example, *for the most part* is tagged as a four-part multi-word adverb: *for*_RR41 *the*_RR42 *most*_RR43 *part*_RR44 (where 'RR' is the tag for 'general adverb', '41' means 'four parts, first part', '42' means 'four parts, second part', and so on). Similarly, *so that* is tagged as a two-part subordinating conjunction, *so*_CS21 *that*_CS22, and *instead of* is tagged as a two-part preposition, *instead*_II21 *of*_II22. A fuller account of how multi-words are treated by CLAWS may be found in the manual which accompanies the tagged version of the British National Corpus (World Edition) at http://www.comp.lancs.ac.uk/ucrel/bnc2/bnc2postag_manual.htm (see the section on "Tokenization: splitting the text into words"). A full list of multi-word expressions so treated by the tagger is also available from that site.

Users of the tagged version of the corpus should familiarize themselves with how 'words' are tokenized, as it affects how search terms are specified when concordancing.

Chapter 4

Statistical overviews and word counts

The four tables provided here give descriptive frequency figures for MICASE, showing the composition of the corpus by speaker and speech event categories. These word counts are for the untagged version of MICASE, and 'words' were defined as strings bounded by spaces or punctuation; hyphenated words (e.g., *eighty-five, cross-sectional, non-native*) and words with apostrophes (e.g., *she'll, shouldn't've, don't, John's*) counted as one word.

Table 4-1 Speaker and word counts by speaker categories

Speaker Category			Total Speakers	Total Words	% of Total Corpus
Gender	Male		**729**	**786,487**	**46%**
	Female		**842**	**909,053**	**54%**
Academic Role*	Faculty		**160**	**825,829**	**49%**
		[Male	*84*	*446,925*	*26%]*
		[Female	*76*	*378,904*	*22%]*
	Students		**1,039**	**742,348**	**44%**
		Undergraduates	782	368,433	22%
		[Male	*336*	*142,102*	*8%]*
		[Female	*446*	*226,331*	*13%]*
		Graduates	257	373,915	22%
		[Male	*121*	*158,696*	*9%]*
		[Female	*136*	*215,219*	*13%]*

Language Status	Native Speakers	**1,449**	**1,493,586**	**88%**
	Non-native speakers	**122**	**201,954**	**12%**
Totals		1,571	1,695,540	

Table 4-2 Speaker and word counts by academic division

Academic Division	Speech Events	Speakers	Words	% of Total Corpus	% Male	% Female	% Faculty*	% Students*
Humanities & Arts	37	368	450,348	27	56	44	63	29
Social Sciences & Education	34	433	404,668	24	37	63	44	55
Biological & Health Sciences	32	257	325,456	19	41	59	55	42
Physical Sciences & Engineering	36	314	358,776	21	55	45	44	52
Other/NA	13	199	156,292	9	37	63	20	41

Table 4-3 Speaker and word counts by interactivity rating

Primary Discourse Mode	Speech Events	Speakers	Words	% of Total Corpus	% Male	% Female	% Faculty *	% Students*
Highly Monologic	14	41	136,239	8	50	50	84	14
Mostly Monologic	37	266	356,525	21	27	73	76	16
Mixed	26	258	256,384	15	46	54	26	63
Mostly Interactive	27	334	381,709	23	51	49	54	39
Highly Interactive	48	520	564,683	33	48	52	28	72

Table 4-4 Speaker and word counts by speech event type

Speech Event Type	Tran-scripts	Speak-ers	Words	% of Total Corpus	% Male	% Female	% Faculty*	% Students*
Advising	2	11	35,275	2.1	13	87	70	30
Colloquia	14	121	157,333	9.3	51	49	89	11
Discussion Sections	9	112	74,904	4.4	37	63	33	67
Diss. Defenses	4	26	56,837	3.4	55	45	37	63
Interviews	3	6	13,015	0.8	83	17	56	44
Labs	8	42	73,815	4.4	70	30	32	68
Large Lectures	30	214	251,632	14.8	54	46	94	6
Small Lectures	32	296	333,338	19.7	46	54	78	22
Meetings	6	60	70,038	4.1	66	34	38	62
Office Hours	14	106	171,188	8.2	41	59	29	71
Seminars	7	72	138,626	7.7	60	40	65	35
Study Groups	8	36	129,725	7.7	32	68	0	100
Student Pres-entations	11	146	143,369	8.5	24	76	22	78
Service En-counters	2	90	24,691	1.5	41	59	40	60
Tours	2	19	21,768	1.3	58	42	39	61

*** Note**: In these tables, percentages for faculty and students do not add up to 100% because of other speaker roles (e.g. staff, researchers, visitors) not included in these counts.

Chapter 5

Using MICASE On-line

MICASE was designed to be freely available to as many researchers, instructors, and students as possible. To that end, since May 2002, the entire corpus has been accessible on the web, on a site with a searchable interface much like a concordance program. In May 2007, the original search interface was updated and now provides some additional functionality (for example, for each search, simple descriptive statistics are provided, and the search results can be downloaded in tab-delimited format). The URL for the MICASE on-line search engine homepage is: http://micase.umdl.umich.edu/m/micase/. This chapter provides help with using this on-line interface.

There are two modes for exploring MICASE on-line: **Browse** and **Search**. The two modes are described very briefly here, followed by more specific directions and suggestions for browsing and searching the corpus.

5.1 Browse MICASE

The browse function returns lists of *transcripts* that match your criteria. *(Please see Sections 2.3 and 2.4 for explanations of transcript and speaker attributes.)*

You can specify

- transcript or speech event parameters (type of event, academic division, academic discipline, participant level, and interactivity level);
- characteristics (gender, age, academic position/role, and native language) of any speaker *participating* in the event.

The list of transcripts returned by the browse function includes each file's ID, transcript name, recording length, and word count.

From this list, you can

- access the transcript of interest by clicking on the file ID in the left-hand column.

5.2 Search MICASE

The search function returns a list of each *occurrence* of the specified word or phrase in concordance format (Key Word in Context). It is possible to search the entire corpus for such occurrences, or you can restrict the search using any speech event or speaker category. *(Please see Sections 2.3 and 2.4 for explanations of speech event and speaker attributes.)*

You must first specify

- the word or phrase of interest.

You can also specify

- attributes of the speech event (type of event, academic division, academic discipline, participant level, and interactivity rating) in which the utterance occurs,
- characteristics of the speaker (gender, age group, academic position/role, and native language) uttering the key word or phrase (see boxed note below).

> Note the difference between selecting speakers in browse vs. search modes: In browse mode, the selected speaker(s) includes *any* speaker participating in the event. In search mode, the selected speaker is the person uttering the search word or phrase.

The concordance results screen displays the total number of matches, the total number of transcripts in which the search term occurs (shown in italics at the top of the page), and for each hit, the transcript ID, the search term (in "Match") and its context (divided into "Left" and "Right" context). The rightmost column also gives links to view more context for each hit.

From this list, you can

- access the transcript of interest by clicking on the transcript ID in the left-hand column,
- display the full utterance by clicking on "view" after the example in question in the "View context" column to the right (from which point you can then access the transcript in which the utterance appears),

- access information about the speaker (native-speaker status, gender, age, and academic position/role) by clicking on "view" to the right, and
- sort the results according to the words appearing to the left or right of the key word(s) by using up to three different sort filters.

Descriptive statistics

The new search interface provides a quick overview of frequency information across speech events and speakers. To access this information, click on "View results statistics" at the top of the results page. This takes you to a new page that begins by giving statistics broken down by transcript. This includes the raw frequency of the search term per transcript, as well as a normalized frequency per 10,000 words. In the leftmost column, there is a link to each transcript in which the search term occurs. The next two tables provide the raw frequency of the hits broken down by academic division and interactivity rating. The final two tables display the raw frequencies by gender and academic role.

Please note that, while this information is meant to give an approximate indication of where interesting differences or similarities may be found in the corpus, we do not provide normalized frequencies for all of the categories. We encourage the user to take into consideration the fact that the distribution of factors like gender and academic roles is not balanced in the corpus, which is why we state that:

> Speaker and speech event categories are not all equally represented or distrib uted in the corpus; for comparative purposes, statistical summaries of all the various speaker and speech event categories can be found at: www.lsa.umich.edu/eli/micase/MICASEStats.htm.

Download results

The new search interface allows you to download your results, including not just the search term and its context, but also metadata about the speaker. This makes it possible to open the results file in a program like Microsoft Excel and, while analyzing the data, to keep track of important speaker data in a relatively convenient way. The name of the transcript in which the search term occurs is also recorded in the results file, which makes it possible to calculate the dispersion of a particular linguistic feature across MICASE, or to determine whether a particular linguistic feature is more frequent in large lectures than study groups. Users who are solely interested in the linguistic data and who wish to disregard the speaker metadata altogether can simply delete those columns from the results file.

The data are arranged in the following order:

- Pre-hit context (words that immediately precede the search term)
- Hit string (the search term)
- Post-hit context (words that immediately follow the search term)

After the initial language data, the metadata appear in individual columns:

- File name
- Transcript ID
- Speaker ID
- Speaker gender
- Speaker role
- Speaker native-speaker status

In order to access these different types of data based on a search, we recommend that you click on "Download results in tab-delimited format" at the top of the results page. (NOTE: The option of downloading results as XML should only be selected by those users who know exactly what the XML format entails and how to deal with it.) Your browser will display a window called "Opening corpus", asking you to either (a) open the file directly or (b) save it to disk.

We recommend that you save the results file onto your hard drive (option b). The file is automatically given the name "corpus" and is downloaded as a simple text file (*.txt*). To retrieve the file and save it as an Excel document, launch Excel and choose "open". Then go to the directory in which downloaded files are saved by default on your computer and select the right file.

Remember to save your document. When you select "Save", the program will give you different options. Choose NO (to preserve the features) and save the file in the latest Excel format, with an *.xls* extension. Navigate to the directory in which you wish to save your file and give it a transparent name.

If you choose option (a), i.e. to open the file by selecting "Open with", you also need to click the Browse button. In the new window that opens, you need to navigate to Microsoft Excel (or some other spreadsheet or word-processing software) on your local hard drive. In Windows, this is usually found in "Program Files", then in "Microsoft Office". If you don't know exactly where to find it, ask any advanced Windows user. Once you have located the "Excel.exe" file, select it, and you will find it in a drop-down box after "Open with". Now click on the OK button, and the tab-delimited data will open in Excel. (NOTE: Before clicking OK, it is possible to check the box that says "Do this automatically for files like this from now on". Doing this would make it possible for you to avoid having to go through these steps in the future.)

Searching for high-frequency words

Like the old search interface, the new search interface has some limitations with respect to search terms that are very frequent. For instance, when you do a search for a word like *the*, your browser ends up having to work very hard in order to display the entire set of results. This may cause your browser to crash. Our solution to this is to implement a threshold for displaying high-frequency hits. What this means is that any time your results exceed 500, you are taken to a threshold page that gives you four options as to how to proceed. The text displayed, which should be self-explanatory, reads as follows:

> **Too many hits...** The threshold for the number of results has been exceeded, which means that your browser may take a long time to render all of your hits. You may choose either to (a) continue with viewing the results (knowing that it may take a while), (b) download them in a separate file in XML format, (c) download them in a separate file in tab-delimited format, or (d) view a summary of the statistics for the results. Make your choice by clicking one of the options below.

Note that this limitation applies to the on-line display of results, and not the downloading. Choosing to download the results in a separate file works well even for highly frequent search terms.

5.3 Tips

IN EITHER MODE	
To select more than one item in a speech event or speaker attribute category	Hold down control key while clicking on additional selections.
IN BROWSE MODE	
To see a list of all available transcripts	Leave speech event and speaker attribute categories set to the default "All."
To see a list of only the transcripts that match certain criteria	Select the type of speech event and speaker attribute(s) of interest.

IN SEARCH MODE	
Types of searches allowed	Single words or multi-word phrases The wildcard character * may be used at the end (but not the beginning) of a search word to represent zero or more characters (e.g., typing in *walk** will give you *walk, walks, walked, walker, walkers,* and *walking*). These characters appear separately to the right of the search word and can be sorted. Current limitations: The search engine does not accept Boolean searches with "OR" (i.e., you cannot search for all instances of two or more terms, e.g., you cannot search for "*woman* OR *women*").
To see concordance lines for any word or phrase used by *any* speaker in *all* transcripts	Enter a word or phrase in the first box of the search page, and leave all speaker and transcript attributes set to "All" (the default setting).
To see concordance lines for any word or phrase used by *any* speaker in *specific types* of speech events only	Enter a word or phrase in the "Find" box on the search page, and select the desired transcript attributes in the rightmost column.
To see concordance lines for any word or phrase used by *specific* speakers in *all* transcripts	Enter a word or phrase in the "Find" box on the search page, and select the desired speaker attributes in the column immediately to the right of the "Find" box.
To see concordance lines for any word or phrase used by *specific* speakers in *specific types* of speech events only	Enter a word or phrase in the "Find" box on the search page. Select the desired transcript attributes in the rightmost column. Select the desired speaker attributes in the column to the left.
To re-sort results	Use pull-down menus at the top of the search results page to specify primary (1), secondary (2), or tertiary (3) sort filters. Sort options include: 1st-5th word to the left or right (1L-5L, 1R-5R) The search term itself (e.g. in cases where the word may or may not be followed by a punctuation mark) **Note: Results returning more than 500 hits can be sorted in the new search interface, although it may take some time.**
To view entire utterance in which search term appears	Click on the "view" hyperlink in the "View context" column to the right.
To see speaker attributes for an utterance	Click on "View context" in right column and a summary of the speaker characteristics is shown at the top of the page.

IN EITHER MODE	
To view entire transcript	Click on name of the transcript (in hypertext) in the "Transcript ID" column to the left. At the top of the transcript view page, you also get some general information about the file (e.g. total number of participants). Click on the hypertext at the end of the file information header to "download entire transcript in XML".
HTML Transcription Conventions	Search term is highlighted **in red**. **Blue text** indicates overlapping speech. **Orange text** indicates embedded turn (different speaker). <L> = laugh <P> = pause longer than 3 seconds <E> = contextual or non-verbal event (identified in utterance and full transcript views) For a full description of all transcription conventions, please see section 3.2
Current limitations	Note that limiting your search by too many speech event or speaker parameters may result in a very small number of hits, or none at all. A special threshold applies to searches for highly frequent words and expressions. Any time your results exceed 500, you are taken to a page that gives you four options as to how to proceed. Although you may continue with viewing the results in your browser, we recommend that you download the results as a tab-delimited file, and then open it in a program like Microsoft Excel. Note that it is not possible to search for transcript mark-up, such as PAUSE, LAUGHTER or WRITING ON THE BLACKBOARD, using the on-line search interface. While you need to have access to the transcripts themselves in order to search for this type of mark-up, you can safely submit a search on-line for words like "pause" and "laugh", and what you will get is linguistic data only. (Note that the mark-up is visible in the context and in the transcripts on-line; the restriction merely applies to actual searches.) If you discover something that does not seem to be working as it should, please let us know by sending a message to micase@umich.edu. We would also appreciate suggestions or comments as to ways in which we could improve the site or the functionality of the on-line search features.

Chapter 6

Distribution, availability, and copyright restrictions

There are two different ways to do research on MICASE. If you have obtained the SGML or XML files, you can use them with your own software on your own computer. Otherwise, you are welcome to use MICASE On-line, our web-based search facility, linked from the MICASE home page. In either case, please familiarize yourself with our copyright restrictions.

6.1 Obtaining a copy of the corpus

From the MICASE On-line site, it is possible to download individual MICASE transcripts and thus obtain a copy of the whole corpus. This involves going through 2 or 3 steps/clicks per transcript to obtain all 152 files. If you want to obtain MICASE by this method, go to the Transcript Header View of the first file you are interested in (by clicking on the filename on the "results" page of either a "Browse" or a "Search"), then choose "Download entire transcript in XML." Repeat this procedure for all the other transcripts. Do note, however, the differences between this on-line version and the CD-ROM distributed version, as listed in section 3.3.2.

If you want to do independent research on MICASE using your own tools or concordance package (e.g., Wordsmith or MonoConc Pro) and want the full, complete texts, you may purchase a single-user or site license for the corpus for a nominal fee. This can be done by filling out the order form, which is downloadable from http://www.lsa.umich.edu/eli/micase/MICASE_OrderForm.pdf.

6.2 Availability of sound files

As of this publication date, a number of the original sound files are available as streamed RealAudio files on the English Language Institute's MICASE website (http://www.lsa.umich.edu/eli/micase/Audio/index.htm). Listening to these files requires only the latest version of the freely downloadable program, RealPlayer. In addition, we have made many of the rest of the audio files available for purchase on CD-rom, compressed in MP3 format. These sound files are available to bona fide academic researchers and teachers who agree to the terms of our license, especially regarding anonymity issues and use of the materials for commercial purposes. Between the freely available RealAudio files and the MP3 files for purchase, most of the original audio files are available; however, some speaker consent restrictions prevent us from making the complete set of recordings publicly available.

6.3 Copyright restrictions and licenses

Obtaining the MICASE corpus implies that you accept the following copyright and license terms:

MICASE copyright statement

The MICASE project is owned by the Regents of the University of Michigan, who hold the copyright. The database has been developed by the English Language Institute, and the web interface by Digital Library Production Services. The original DAT audiotapes are held in the English Language Institute and may be consulted by bona fide researchers under special arrangements. The database is freely available at the MICASE website for study, teaching, and research purposes, and copies of the transcripts may be distributed, as long as either this statement of availability or the citation given below appears in the text. However, if any portion of this material is to be used for commercial purposes, such as for textbooks or tests, permission must be obtained in advance and a license fee may be required. Furthermore, some restrictions apply on the citation of specific portions of some of the transcripts in educational presentations and publications; all such restrictions are noted in the headers of individual files of the corpus. For further information about copyright permission, please contact Dr. Sarah Briggs at slbriggs@umich.edu. The recommended citation for MICASE is: R. C. Simpson, S. L. Briggs, J. Ovens, and J. M. Swales. (2002) The Michigan Corpus of Academic Spoken English. Ann Arbor, MI: The Regents of the University of Michigan.

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Appendix A
Index of Transcripts

File ID	File name	# of speakers	Recording length (mins.)	Transcript word count
adv700ju023	Honors Advising	4	52	9209
adv700ju047	Academic Advising	7	124	26065
col140mx114	Peking Opera Colloquium	13	74	11299
col200mx133	Chemical Biology Colloquium	10	63	9941
col285mx038	Education Colloquium	9	52	7898
col385mu054	Public Math Colloquium	3	51	7236
col425mx075	Ecological Agriculture Colloquium	8	97	17061
col475mx082	Philosophy Colloquium	13	95	15232
col485mx069	Nobel Laureate Physics Lecture	9	87	14476
col575mx055	Golden Apple Award Statistics Lecture	3	45	5688
col605mx039	Women's Studies Guest Lecture	5	65	9386
col605mx132	Christianity and the Modern Family Colloquium	14	78	11027
col999mg053	Career Planning and Placement Workshop	12	76	11324
col999mx036	Provost Public Lecture	4	61	8823
col999mx040	Women in Science Conference Panel	11	105	18671
col999mx059	Problem-Solving Colloquium	7	66	9265
def270sf061	Artificial Intelligence Dissertation Defense	6	113	20621
def305mx131	Fossil Plants Defense	9	57	9558
def420mx022	Music Dissertation Defense	6	91	14982
def500sf016	Social Psychology Dissertation Defense	5	76	11676
dis115ju087	Intro Anthropology Discussion Section	17	51	7893
dis150ju130	Intro Astronomy Discussion Section	4	33	5338
dis175ju081	Intro Biology Discussion Section	22	59	6899
dis175su027	Biology of Birds Discussion Section	11	55	7424
dis195su117	Heat and Mass Transfer Discussion Section	4	48	7570
dis280su058	Economics Discussion Section	8	61	8526
dis315ju101	History Review Discussion Section	19	119	15679

File ID	File name	# of speakers	Recording length (mins.)	Transcript word count
dis475mu012	Philosophy Discussion Section	9	51	8355
dis495ju119	Intro to American Politics Discussion Section	18	55	7220
int175sf003	Interview with Botanist	2	31	5016
int425jg001	Graduate Student Research Interview 1	2	34	5063
int425jg002	Graduate Student Research Interview 2	2	20	2936
lab175su026	Biology of Birds Field Lab	0	92	10696
lab175su032	Biology of Fishes Field Lab	3	89	10617
lab175su033	Biology of Fishes Lab	1	95	7246
lab200ju018	Chemistry Lab	2	47	7511
lab205su045	Hydraulics Problem-Solving Lab	10	78	9457
lab500su044	Biopsychology Lab	9	52	8847
lab500su089	Cognitive Psychology Research Lab	12	82	13623
lab575ju095	Intro to Statistics Lab	5	47	5818
lel105su113	History of the American Family Lecture	9	81	10621
lel115ju090	Intro Anthropology Lecture	2	74	11206
lel115su005	Medical Anthropology Lecture	5	69	11470
lel115su107	Race and Human Evolution Lecture	8	77	9395
lel140su074	Japanese Literature Lecture	7	44	8213
lel175ju086	Practical Botany Lecture	1	48	3788
lel175ju112	General Ecology Lecture	6	51	4331
lel175ju154	Intro to Evolution Lecture	3	98	11699
lel175mu014	Intro Biology First Day Lecture	7	47	6613
lel175su098	Intro to Biochemistry Lecture	11	82	7917
lel175su106	Biology of Cancer Lecture	2	70	10964
lel185su066	Behavior Theory Management Lecture	49	80	12698
lel195su120	Separation Processes	8	48	4277
lel200ju105	Inorganic Chemistry Lecture	1	50	6532
lel200mu110	Structure and Reactivity II Lecture	8	45	3815
lel215su150	Sports and Daily Life in Ancient Rome Lecture	1	71	12581
lel220ju071	Intro Communication Lecture	2	76	7682
lel220su073	Media Impact in Communication Lecture	13	72	9164
lel280jg051	Graduate Macroeconomics Lecture	7	76	7865
lel295ju035	Intro Engineering Lecture	6	52	5563
lel300su020	Literature and Social Change Lecture	3	84	9568
lel300su076	Fantasy in Literature Lecture	7	83	12682
lel305ju092	Intro Oceanography Lecture	10	63	8175

File ID	File name	# of speakers	Recording length (mins.)	Transcript word count
lel320ju143	Renaissance to Modern Art History Lecture	2	50	7951
lel320ju147	Twentieth Century Arts	4	41	5981
lel485ju097	Intro to Physics Lecture	1	49	7220
lel500ju034	Intro Psychology Lecture	1	47	7266
lel500su088	Drugs of Abuse Lecture	5	68	9623
lel542su096	Perspectives on the Holocaust Lecture	9	100	6521
lel565su064	Principles in Sociology Lecture	16	82	10246
les115mu151	Archeology of Modern American Life Lecture	16	73	10463
les165jg121	Rehabilitation Engineering and Technology	9	49	7025
les175su025	Biology and Ecology of Fishes Lecture	6	70	9326
les175su028	Biology of Birds Lecture	7	84	11417
les175su031	Biology of Fishes Group Activity	1	19	2705
les175su079	Microbial Genetics Lecture	8	85	12264
les205jg124	Intro to Groundwater Hydrology Lecture	11	82	13334
les215mu056	Intro Latin Lecture	9	50	5460
les220su140	Ethics Issues in Journalism Lecture	24	83	15305
les235su099	Intro Programming Lecture	6	50	7623
les280jg138	Labor Economics Lecture	6	77	11822
les300su103	American Literature Lecture	14	99	15385
les305mu108	Dynamic Earth Lecture	9	51	6753
les315su129	African History Lecture	10	68	8755
les320su085	Visual Sources Lecture	12	69	11493
les330jg052	Graduate Industrial Operations Engineering Lecture	6	81	10096
les335jg065	Graduate Online Search and Database Lecture	24	147	18039
les355su009	Historical Linguistics Lecture	6	69	12569
les365vo029	Professional Mechanical Engineering Seminar	7	90	12445
les385su007	Number Theory Math Lecture	10	36	3585
les405jg078	Graduate Cellular Biotechnology Lecture	4	83	12584
les420mg134	Beethoven Lecture	11	75	7161
les425jg077	Graduate Population Ecology Lecture	4	44	5041
les425su093	Spring Ecosystems Lecture	7	74	10678
les445su067	Radiological Health Engineering Lecture	10	98	12876
les485mg006	Graduate Physics Lecture	7	105	13008
les495ju063	Political Science Lecture	6	96	14806
les500ju136	Honors Intro Psychology	4	49	5531

File ID	File name	# of speakers	Recording length (mins.)	Transcript word count
les500su102	Intro to Psychopathology Lecture	2	52	7938
les565mx152	Statistics in Social Sciences Lecture	10	109	15432
les565su137	Sex, Gender, and the Body Lecture	20	73	13153
les605su080	Women in the Bible Lecture	10	75	9266
mtg270sg049	Artificial Intelligence Research Group Meeting	7	94	16760
mtg400mx008	Immunology Lab Meeting	6	60	8394
mtg425jg004	Natural Resources Research Group Meeting	5	83	9130
mtg485sg142	Physics Research Group Meeting	8	41	8504
mtg999st015	Forum for International Educators Meeting	11	102	14910
mtg999su043	Student Government Meeting	23	66	12340
ofc105su068	American Culture Advising	5	42	8135
ofc115su060	Anthropology of American Cities Office Hours	6	178	29635
ofc150mu042	Astronomy Peer Tutoring	12	102	19763
ofc175ju145	Intro Biology Exam Review	9	55	8221
ofc195su116	Heat and Mass Transfer Office Hours	23	137	19498
ofc270mg048	Computer Science Office Hours	11	116	19044
ofc280su109	Economics Office Hours	10	92	13114
ofc285sg135	Graduate Education Advising	2	54	8829
ofc300ju149	Intro to Poetry Office Hours	4	88	11638
ofc301mu021	English Composition Tutorial	4	45	3303
ofc320su153	Art History Office Hours	5	66	8971
ofc355su094	Linguistics Independent Study Advising	2	52	6579
ofc575mu046	Statistics Office Hours	11	52	10508
ofc578mx037	Technical Communications Tutorial	2	25	3948
sem140jg070	Graduate Buddhist Studies Seminar	8	167	21537
sem300mu100	English Composition Seminar	11	125	20113
sem340jg072	Graduate Public Policy Seminar	11	143	24180
sem475ju084	First Year Philosophy Seminar	13	72	10300
sem475mx041	Graduate Philosophy Seminar	3	125	20979
sem495su111	Politics of Higher Education	19	108	18687
sem545mg083	Graduate French Cinema Seminar	7	169	22830
sgr175mu126	Intro Biology Study Group	5	103	22422
sgr175su123	Biochemistry Study Group	4	109	16192
sgr195su127	Chemical Engineering Group Project Meeting	4	77	10386

File ID	File name	# of speakers	Recording length (mins.)	Transcript word count
sgr200ju125	Organic Chemistry Study Group	6	101	16377
sgr385su057	Math Study Group	3	132	16130
sgr565su144	American Family Group Project Meeting	5	85	13388
sgr999mx115	Objectivism Student Group	5	125	20830
sgr999su146	Undergraduate Social Science Thesis Study Group	4	64	14000
stp095su139	Black Media Student Presentations	13	66	9282
stp125jg050	Architecture Critiques	12	123	22596
stp165jg122	Rehab Engineering and Technology Student Presentations	5	32	5241
stp175su141	Teaching Biochemistry Student Presentations	18	121	17224
stp200ju019	Chemistry Discussion Section Student Presentations	18	51	6575
stp285su013	Multicultural Issues in Education Student Presentations	11	72	12354
stp355mg011	Bilingualism Student Presentations	7	99	15153
stp355su010	Second Language Acquisition Student Presentations	12	69	9791
stp450sg128	Nursing Student Presentations	10	155	22223
stp545ju091	Brazilian Studies Student Presentations	14	78	12345
stp560jg118	Community Change Student Presentations	26	66	10585
svc999mx104	Media Union Service Encounters	79	187	17093
svc999mx148	Science Learning Center Service Encounters	11	121	7598
tou999ju030	Freshman Orientation Tour	11	77	12995
tou999mx062	Art Museum Tour	8	66	8773

Appendix B
The CLAWS C8++ Tag set

[* Tags which are different from the C7 tag set are in bold]

APPGE	possessive pronoun, pre-nominal (e.g. "my", "your", "our")
AT	article (e.g. "the", "no")
AT1	singular article (e.g. "a", "an", "every")
BCL	before-clause marker (e.g. "in order (that)", "in order (to)")
CC	coordinating conjunction (e.g. "and", "or")
CCB	adversative coordinating conjunction ("but")
CS	subordinating conjunction (e.g. "if", "because", "unless", "so", "for")
CSA	"as" (as conjunction)
CSN	"than" (as conjunction)
CST	"that" (as conjunction)
CSW	"whether" (as conjunction)
DA	after-determiner or post-determiner capable of pronominal function (e.g. "such", "former", "same")
DA1	singular after-determiner (e.g. "little", "much")
DA2	plural after-determiner (e.g. "few", "several", "many")
DAR	comparative after-determiner (e.g. "more", "less", "fewer")
DAT	superlative after-determiner (e.g. "most", "least", "fewest")
DB	before determiner or pre-determiner capable of pronominal function ("all", "half")
DB2	plural before-determiner ("both")
DD	determiner (capable of pronominal function) (e.g. "any", "some")
DD1	singular determiner (e.g. "this", "that", "another")
DD2	plural determiner ("these", "those")
DDL	**wh-determiner, relative ("which")**
DDLGE	**wh-determiner, relative, genitive ("whose")**
DDQ	wh-determiner, interrogative ("which", "what")
DDQGE	wh-determiner, interrogative, genitive ("whose")
DDQV	wh-ever determiner, interrogative ("whichever", "whatever")
EX	existential "there"
FO	formula
FU	unclassified word
FW	foreign word
GE	germanic genitive marker - (' or 's)
IF	"for" (as preposition)
II	general preposition

IO	"of" (as preposition)
IW	"with", "without" (as prepositions)
JJ	general adjective
JJR	general comparative adjective (e.g. "older", "better", "stronger")
JJT	general superlative adjective (e.g. "oldest", "best", "strongest")
JK	catenative adjective ("able" in "be able to", "willing" in "be willing to")
MC	cardinal number, neutral for number ("two", "three"..)
MC1	singular cardinal number ("one")
MC2	plural cardinal number (e.g. "sixes", "sevens")
MCGE	genitive cardinal number, neutral for number ("two's", "100's")
MCMC	hyphenated number ("40-50", "1770-1827")
MD	ordinal number (e.g. "first", "second", "next", "last")
MF	fraction, neutral for number (e.g. "quarters", "two-thirds")
ND1	singular noun of direction (e.g. "north", "southeast")
NN	common noun, neutral for number (e.g. "sheep", "cod", "headquarters")
NN1	singular common noun (e.g. "book", "girl")
NN2	plural common noun (e.g. "books", "girls")
NNA	following noun of title (e.g. "M.A.")
NNB	preceding noun of title (e.g. "Mr.", "Prof.")
NNL1	singular locative noun, in naming expression (e.g. "Island", "Street")
NNL2	plural locative noun (e.g. "Islands", as in "Virgin Islands")
NNO	numeral noun, neutral for number (e.g. "dozen", "hundred")
NNO2	numeral noun, plural (e.g. "hundreds", "thousands")
NNT1	temporal noun, singular (e.g. "day", "week", "year")
NNT2	temporal noun, plural (e.g. "days", "weeks", "years")
NNU	unit of measurement, neutral for number (e.g. "in", "cc")
NNU1	singular unit of measurement (e.g. "inch", "centimetre")
NNU2	plural unit of measurement (e.g. "ins.", "feet")
NP	proper noun, neutral for number (e.g. "IBM", "Andes")
NP1	singular proper noun (e.g. "London", "Jane", "Frederick")
NP2	plural proper noun (e.g. "Browns", "Reagans", "Koreas")
NPD1	singular weekday noun (e.g. "Sunday")
NPD2	plural weekday noun (e.g. "Sundays")
NPM1	singular month noun (e.g. "October")
NPM2	plural month noun (e.g. "Octobers")
PN	indefinite pronoun, neutral for number ("none")
PN1	indefinite pronoun, singular (e.g. "anyone", "everything", "nobody", "one")
PNLO	**objective wh-pronoun, relative ("whom")**
PNLS	**subjective wh-pronoun, relative ("whom")**
PNQO	objective wh-pronoun, interrogative ("whom")
PNQS	subjective wh-pronoun, interrogative ("who")
PNQV	wh-ever pronoun ("whoever")
PNX1	reflexive indefinite pronoun ("oneself")
PPGE	nominal possessive personal pronoun (e.g. "mine", "yours")

PPH1	3rd person sing. neuter personal pronoun ("it")
PPHO1	3rd person sing. objective personal pronoun ("him", "her")
PPHO2	3rd person plural objective personal pronoun ("them")
PPHS1	3rd person sing. subjective personal pronoun ("he", "she")
PPHS2	3rd person plural subjective personal pronoun ("they")
PPIO1	1st person sing. objective personal pronoun ("me")
PPIO2	1st person plural objective personal pronoun ("us")
PPIS1	1st person sing. subjective personal pronoun ("I")
PPIS2	1st person plural subjective personal pronoun ("we")
PPX1	singular reflexive personal pronoun (e.g. "yourself", "itself")
PPX2	plural reflexive personal pronoun (e.g. "yourselves", "themselves")
PPY	2nd person personal pronoun ("you")
RA	adverb, after nominal head (e.g. "else", "galore")
REX	adverb introducing appositional constructions ("namely", "e.g.")
RG	degree adverb ("very", "so", "too")
RGQ	wh- degree adverb ("how")
RGQV	wh-ever degree adverb ("however")
RGR	comparative degree adverb ("more", "less")
RGT	superlative degree adverb ("most", "least")
RL	locative adverb (e.g. "alongside", "forward")
RP	prep. adverb, particle (e.g. "about", "in")
RPK	prep. adv., catenative ("about" in "be about to")
RR	general adverb
RRQ	wh- general adverb ("where", "when", "why", "how")
RRQV	wh-ever general adverb ("wherever", "whenever")
RRR	comparative general adverb (e.g. "better", "longer")
RRT	superlative general adverb (e.g. "best", "longest")
RT	quasi-nominal adverb of time (e.g. "now", "tomorrow")
TO	infinitive marker ("to")
UH	interjection (e.g. "oh", "yes", "um")

[The following three tags are unique to MICASE:]

UHY	**interjection, positive (e.g. *uh-huh, yuh-huh*)**
UHN	**interjection, negative (e.g. *uh-uh, huh-uh, m-m, hm-m, nuh-uh*)**
UHE	**interjection, exclamatory (e.g. *uh-oh, oh-oh, oops*)**
VAB0	**base form of verb "BE" (auxiliary), imperative or subjunctive**
VABDR	**"were" (auxiliary)**
VABDZ	**"was" (auxiliary)**
VABG	**"being" (auxiliary)**
VABI	**"be" infinitive (auxiliary)**
VABM	**"am" (auxiliary)**
VABN	**"been" (auxiliary)**
VABR	**"are" (auxiliary)**
VABZ	**"is" (auxiliary)**
VVB0	**base form of "BE" (lexical vb), imperative or subjunctive**
VVBDR	**"were" (lexical vb)**

VVBDZ **"was" (lexical vb)**
VVBG **"being" (lexical vb)**
VVBI **"be" infinitive (lexical vb)**
VVBM **"am" (lexical vb)**
VVBN **"been" (lexical vb)**
VVBR **"are" (lexical vb)**
VVBZ **"is" (lexical vb)**
VAD0 **base form of verb "DO" (auxiliary), indicative, imperative or subjunctive**
VADD **"did" (auxiliary)**
VADZ **"does" (auxiliary)**
VVD0 **base form of verb "do" (finite)**
VVDD **"did"**
VVDG **"doing"**
VVDI **"do" infinitive ("I may do..." "To do...")**
VVDN **"done"**
VVDZ **"does"**
VAH0 **base form of "HAVE" (auxiliary), indicative, imperative or subjunctive**
VAHD **"had" (past tense)**
VAHG **"having"**
VAHI **"have" infinitive**
VAHZ **"has"**
VVH0 **base form of verb "HAVE" (finite)**
VVHD **"had" (past tense)**
VVHG **"having"**
VVHI **"have" infinitive**
VVHN **"had" (past participle)**
VVHZ **"has"**
VM modal auxiliary ("can", "will", "would", etc.)
VMK modal catenative ("ought", "used")
VV0 base form of lexical verb (e.g. "give", "work")
VVD past tense of lexical verb (e.g. "gave", "worked")
VVG -ing participle of lexical verb (e.g. "giving", "working")
VVGK -ing participle catenative ("going" in "be going to")
VVI infinitive (e.g. "to give..." "It will work...")
VVN past participle of lexical verb (e.g. "given", "worked")
VVNK past participle catenative (e.g. "bound" in "be bound to")
VVZ -s form of lexical verb (e.g. "gives", "works")
WPR **relative pronoun, "that"**
XX "not", "n't"

[Note: In the current tagged version of MICASE, the question mark is the only punctuation mark used.]

YBL **punctuation tag - left bracket**
YBR **punctuation tag - right bracket**

YCOL	**punctuation tag - colon**
YCOM	**punctuation tag - comma**
YDSH	**punctuation tag - dash**
YEX	**punctuation tag - exclamation mark**
YLIP	**punctuation tag - ellipsis**
YQUE	**punctuation tag - question mark**
YQUO	**punctuation tag - quotes**
YSCOL	**punctuation tag - semicolon**
YSTP	**punctuation tag - full-stop**
ZZ1	singular letter of the alphabet (e.g. "A", "b")
ZZ2	plural letter of the alphabet (e.g. "A's", "b's")

Appendix C
MICASE-based Publications

This appendix lists publications (including doctoral dissertations) which have drawn on the MICASE corpus. In addition to these references, on our website (http://www.lsa.umich.edu/eli/micase/index.htm) we have several sets of sample pedagogical materials and "Kibbitzers" (snippets of research/language notes for ESL purposes) based on MICASE, under the section "Pedagogical and other forays". The conference presentations based on MICASE have become quite numerous, w we do not list them in this version of the MICASE Manual. For a list of conference presentations, scroll down to the end of http://www.lsa.umich.edu/eli/micase/ publications.htm.

Publications

2007

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Escudero, M. The gender of power relations in academic speech: a cross-disciplinary approach. pp. 45-58.

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Lorés, R. Academic literacy vs academic oracy: signaling nouns as devices of intratranslation. pp. 89-114.

Murillo, S. Developing the message: retake phenomena in scientific lectures. pp. 115-130.

Vázquez, I. A corpus-based approach to nominalization in academic lectures. pp. 131-152.

Guillén, I. The use of ideational grammatical metaphor in academic spoken English. pp. 153-181.

Plo, R. Vagueness and imprecise numbers in the hard disciplines of the MICASE. pp. 185-208.

Artiga, R. "I think I know what you are saying." Epistemic lexical verbs as stance markers in American academic speech. pp. 209-236.

Aixalá, I. "What we mean is actually how we mean." A contribution to the analysis of sociopragmatic aspects of MICASE discussion sections. pp. 237-256.

Gabás, L. How to arrange MICASE-based pedagogical materials for the teaching/learning of EAP vocabulary. pp. 257-278.

2005

Fortanet, I. Interaction in Academic Spoken English: the use of "I" and "You" in the MICASE. In E. Macià, A. Cervera & C. Ramos (eds.) *Information Technology in Languages for Spedific Purposes: Issues and Prospects*, pp. 35-52. Springer: New York.

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